

Jacoby Two Notrump

A 2NT response to a Major suit opening promises at least 4-card support and at least opening hand strength. It is absolutely forcing to game.

Opener's second bid describes her hand further:

- 4 of the Major shows a minimum featureless hand

- 3NT shows extra strength and a 5-card trump suit

- 3 of the Major shows extra strength and a 6+ card trump suit

- 3 of any other suit shows shortness (singleton or void)

- 4 of any other suit shows a second 5-card suit

Splinter Bids

A double-jump-shift as a response to partner's opening 1 of a Major suit is a Splinter bid. It shows opening hand strength, at least four card support for the Major, and a singleton or void in the "splintered" suit. It is absolutely forcing to game.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these conventions.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 4 ♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣A

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 4 ♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♣10

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 4 ♥
Declarer: South
Lead: ♦2

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 4 ♠
Declarer: West
Lead: ♣4

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 6 ♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣K

Board: 6
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 6 ♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♦A

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 8
 ♥ 10 8 2
 ♦ 9 7 2
 ♣ 9 8 7 6 4 3

♠ A Q 10 6 4

♥ K Q J 7

♦ K J

♣ J 5



♠ 5 3
 ♥ 6 4 3
 ♦ A 10 8 6 4 3
 ♣ A 2

♠ K J 9 7 2

♥ A 9 5

♦ Q 5

♣ K Q 10

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT	Pass	4♥
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by North			
Lead: ♣A			

NORTH indicates an above normal opening with five ♠s by her 3NT rebid.

SOUTH also has some extra strength so he makes a Control showing bid of 4♥.

Despite both partners showing extra strength North merely signs off at 4♠. Why? Because SOUTH's Control bid of 4♥ denied first-round control in both ♣s and ♦s. NORTH realized she was off two Aces.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 7 6 3
♥ A Q 8 4
♦ 9 4
♣ K Q 2

♠ 10 4

♥ 10 5 2

♦ A J 6

♣ A J 6 5 3



♠ K Q J 8 5

♥ K J 7

♦ Q 8 5

♣ 8 4

♠ 9 2

♥ 9 6 3

♦ K 10 7 3 2

♣ 10 9 7

EAST has a minimum opening hand with no extra features to brag about. So after WEST's Jacoby 2NT bid he merely signs off at 4♠.

WEST would have cooperated if EAST had made a slam try, but she doesn't have enough to initiate the investigation herself.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		1♠	Pass
2NT	Pass	4♠	
All Pass			
4♠ by East			
Lead: ♣10			

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 10 9
♥ 9 6
♦ J 8 2
♣ 10 8 6 3 2

♠ A 7 6 5

♥ Q J 10 7

♦ K Q 7 5

♣ 4



♠ J 3 2

♥ 5 3

♦ A 10 9 6 3

♣ A Q 7

♠ Q 8 4

♥ A K 8 4 2

♦ 4

♣ K J 9 5

NORTH's 4♣ is a Splinter bid. He promises 13+ points, at least four ♥s and a singleton or void in ♣s.

SOUTH is obviously forced to game, but she is not thrilled to hear about NORTH's ♣ shortness. In fact, it does nothing to help the value of her hand. So she bids the ♥ game.

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♥
All Pass			
4♥ by South			
Lead: ♦ 2			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A Q 9 8 6 4

♥ Q J 7

♦ J 2

♣ K Q

♠ 2

♥ 9 5 3 2

♦ A 10 7 6

♣ 10 6 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K J 7 5

♥ K 6

♦ K Q 9 8

♣ J 8 3

♠ 10 3

♥ A 10 8 4

♦ 5 4 3

♣ A 9 7 5

West

1 ♠

3 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by West

Lead: ♣4

North

Pass

Pass

East

2NT

4 ♠

South

Pass

WEST bids 3♠ to show the 6-card suit plus some extra strength.

EAST's failure to make a Control bid in either ♣s, ♦s or ♥s, means just one thing - She doesn't have any controls.

So WEST settles for game.

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 5 4 2

♥ 4 2

♦ 8 2

♣ J 10 8 5 4

♠ K Q

♥ A J 10 9 7 6

♦ 9 7

♣ A 9 6



♠ 10 7 6

♥ 5

♦ Q J 10 6 5 3

♣ K Q 3

♠ A 9 8 3

♥ K Q 8 3

♦ A K 4

♣ 7 2

NORTH's 3♥ bid shows extra strength and a 6-trump hand.

The next three bids are all Control-showing cue bids.

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

Pass

2NT

Pass

3♥

Pass

3♠

Pass

4♣

Pass

4♦

Pass

6♥

All Pass

6♥ by North

Lead: ♣K

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 7 6 3

♥ J 8 3

♦ K Q

♣ A K 8 3

♠ J 2

♥ 10 9 6 2

♦ 7 5 4 3

♣ 7 5 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A Q 9 8 4

♥ A K 4

♦ 9 8

♣ Q J 2

♠ 10 5

♥ Q 7 5

♦ A J 10 6 2

♣ 10 9 6

EAST shows extra strength / five trumps. 4♣ and 4♥ are Control-showing bids.

WEST knows they are missing the ♦ A, she uses Blackwood just to make certain EAST holds the trump Ace.

West	North	East	South
		1 ♠	Pass
2NT	Pass	3NT	Pass
4♣	Pass	4♥	Pass
4NT	Pass	5♥	Pass
6♠			
All Pass			
6♠ by East			
Lead: ♦ A			